

A LITTLE BOOK
OF BORES

By OLIVER HERFORD

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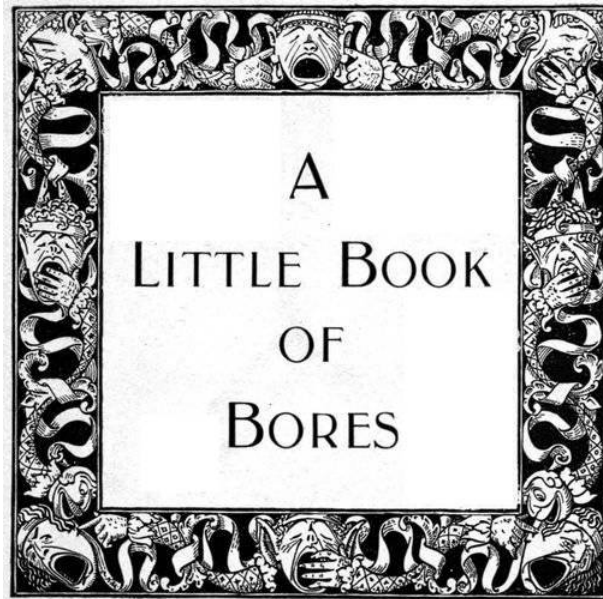
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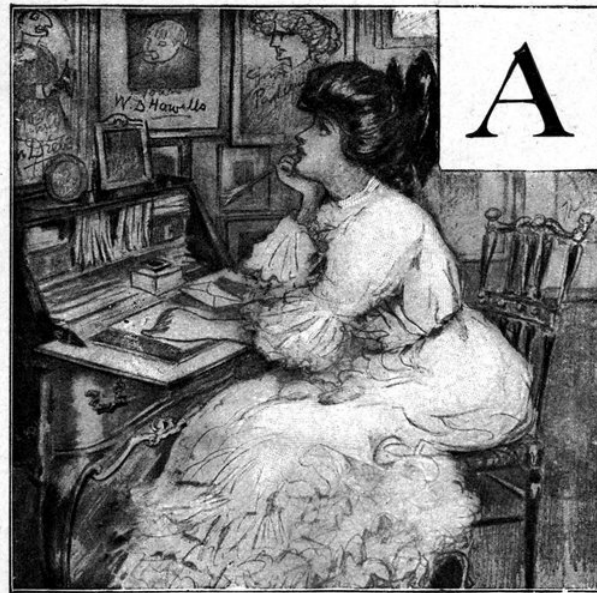
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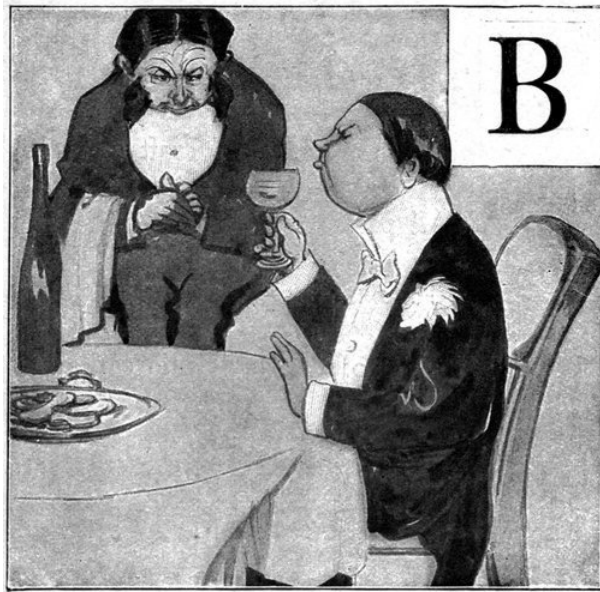


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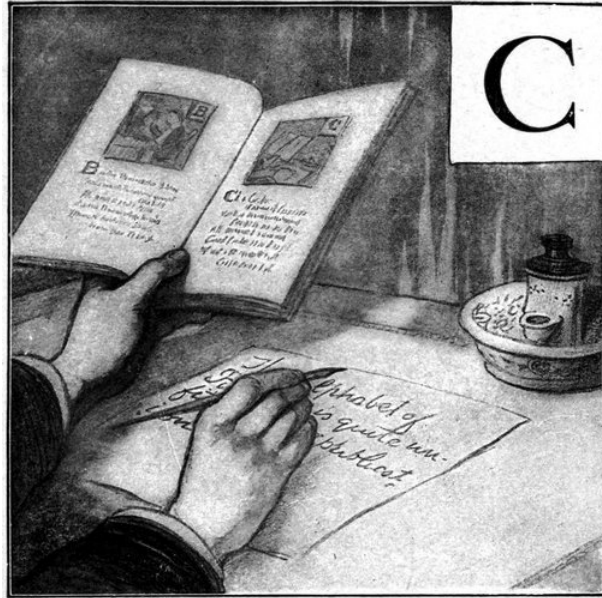
A is the Autograph Bore
Whom Authors and Actors deplore,
Tho' it's evident quite
If the Dears ceased to write
They'd deplore even more than before.



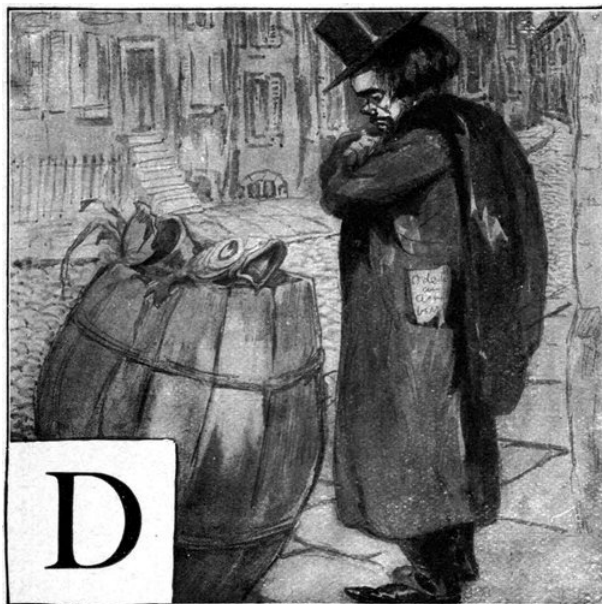
B is a Bounder *blasé*
Who likes to appear quite *au fait*;
He purses his lips
As his Rhine wine he sips,
Tho' he doesn't know Hock from Tokay.



C's a Critic. Far be it from me
With a time-honoured craft to make free.
All praise I accord
Good Critics—but lord!
What a Bore a *bad* Critic can be!



C is a Decadent Dreary
 Whose Works are depressing and eerie;
 If you ask his excuse
 For existence, or use,
 I'm afraid I can't answer your query.



E is the Egotist dread

Who, as some one has happily said,
Will talk till he's blue
About *myself*, when you
Want to talk about *yourself* instead.

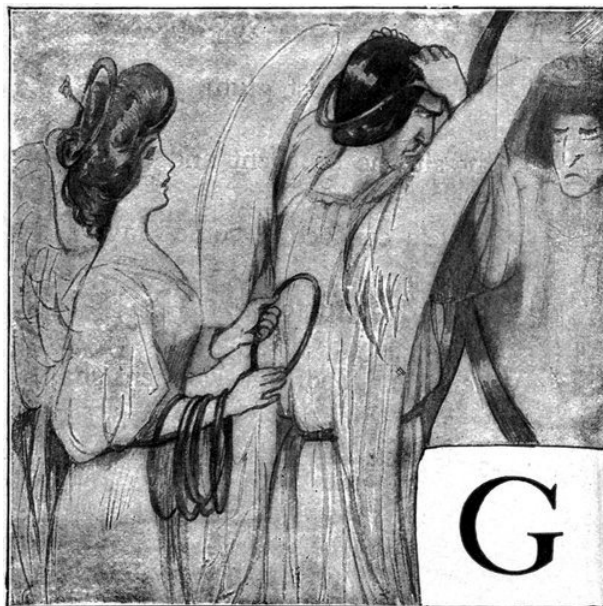


F's a Frankly Familiar Friend

Who loves free advice to extend;
He declares, for his part,
He knows nothing of Art,
But he thinks that your time you misspend.



G is a Grumbler gruff
Whom everything puts in a huff;
If he chances to gain
Heaven's gate, he'll complain
Of his Halo or Harp, like enough.



H is a Humorist glum.

Why sits he so silent and dumb?

He's concocting some Gay

Impromptu to say

When the Opportune Moment shall come.



I's the Intensely Intense

Who dilates on the *Whither* and *Whence*,

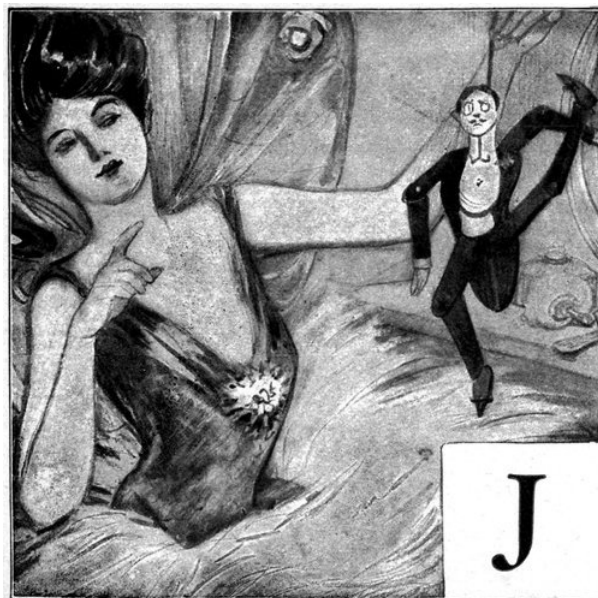
The *Ego* (or "I"),

And the *Wherefore* and *Why*,

Not to mention the *Hither* and *Hence*.



J is the “Johnnie”—a Thing
Much affected by Fairies who sing.
He is human in shape,
With the brain of an ape,
And generally tied to a string.



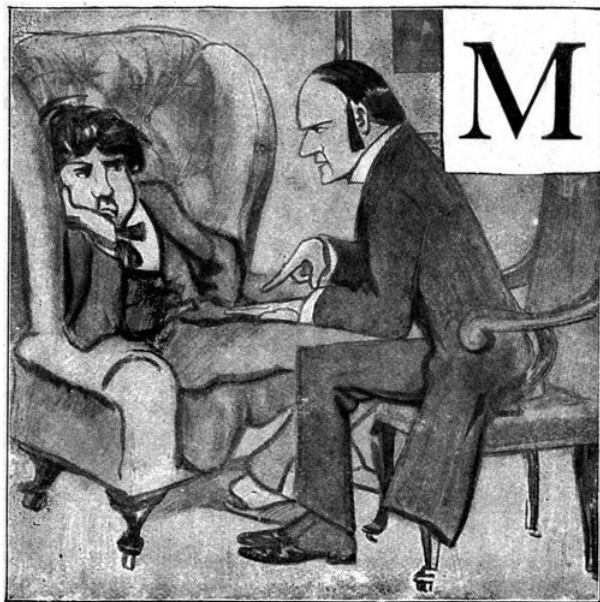
K is the Kaiser unnerving,
With the Terrible Moustache upcurving.
One man who can bore
A planet—and more
Is surely of mention deserving.



L's the Loquacious variety,
That is found in all sorts of society.
He will drink in the sound
Of his own voice—till drowned
In a species of self-inebriety.



L's a Methodical Man
 Who prates with precision and plan.
 Beware, how you balk
 The stream of his talk,
 Lest he go back to where he began.



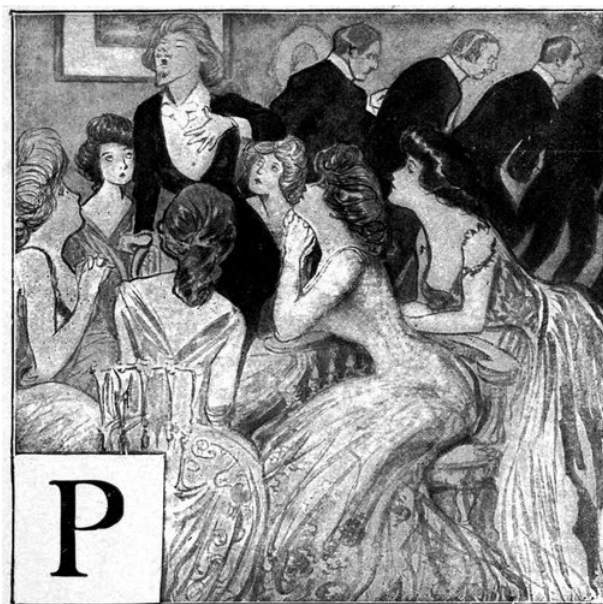
N is a Newly-rich boor,
Whom no one pretends to endure.
Some cases with care
And complete change of Heir
Take three generations to cure.



O is an Optimist glad
Who doesn't know how to be sad;
If he wakes up some day
In Hades, he'll say,
"Well, really it isn't so bad."



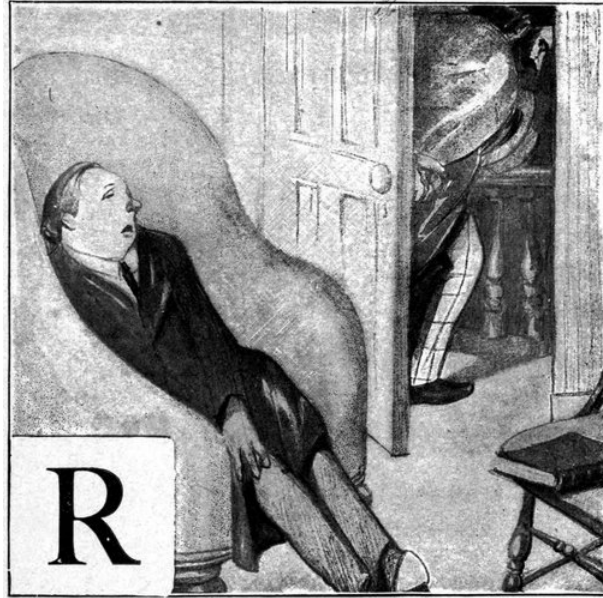
P's a Poetical bore
Who recites his own things by the score.
The ladies, poor dears,
Are all moved to tears,
While strong men are moved—to the door.



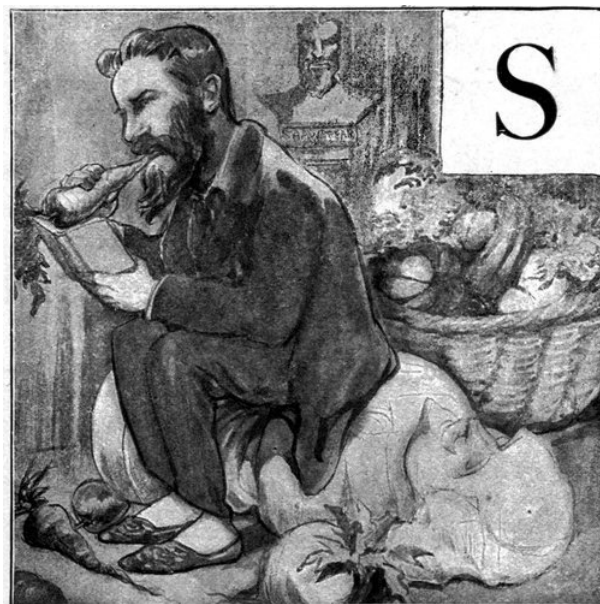
Q is a Quoter who'll cite
His favourite authors all night.
Tho' teeming with Thought,
Like the Moon he is naught
But a second-hand dealer in Light.



R's a Rampant Reformer whose prose
Insures you a Health-giving doze.
You wouldn't much mind
If he'd only be kind
And *not* slam the door when he goes.



S is a Satirist rude
Who subsists on Leguminous Food,
Which he shyly maintains
So enforces his brains,
Even Shakespeare beside him seems crude.



T is a Terrible Tot

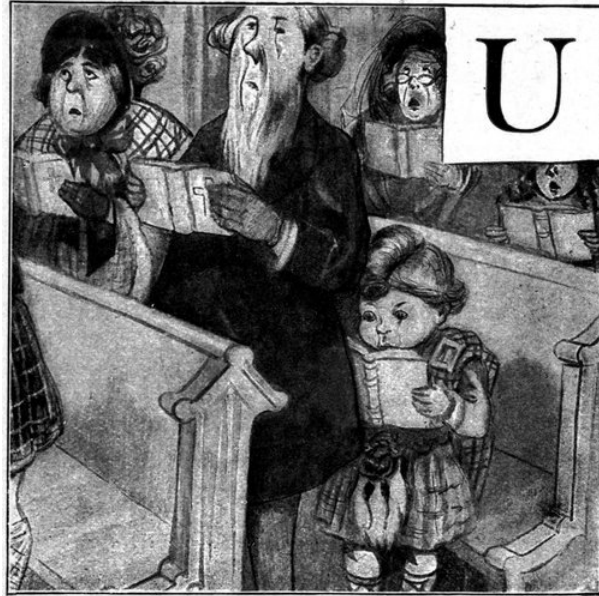
Who says things he'd much better not.

A child of that age
Should be kept in a cage,
And fed—if at all—through a slot.



U is the Unco Guid Man,

And all his unspeakable clan,
With their *Braw bonnie brae*,
Bide a wee, Scots wha hae,
Aweel, Dinna ken, and Hoot man.

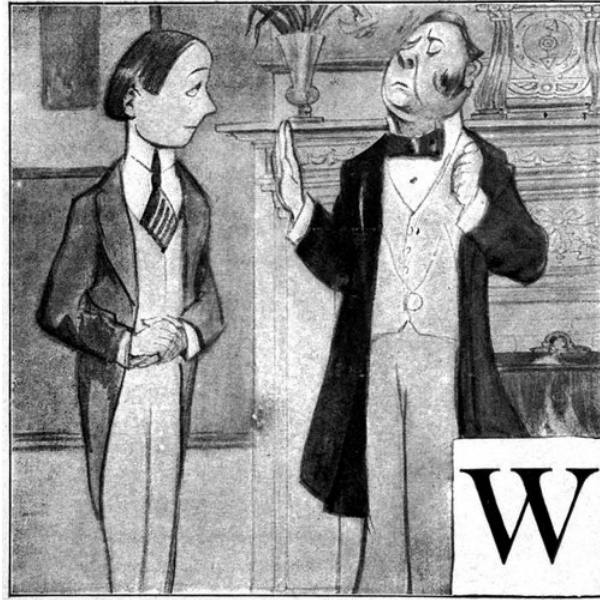


V is a Vain Virtuoso.

If you ask, "Pray what makes your hair grow so;
Do you think it a sign
Of Genius divine?"
He replies, "I don't think so, I *know* so."



W's a Well-informed Wight
Who aims to set every one right;
If you chance to misspell
Or misquote, he will swell
With holy and chastened Delight.



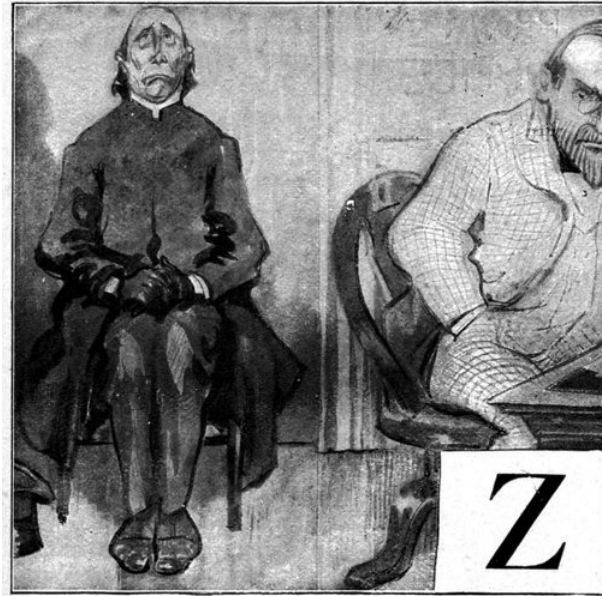
X is Old Xmas, a dear
Old Impostor who comes once a year,
With wassail, and wishes,
And death-dealing dishes,
And chilblains, and chimes, and good cheer.



Y is a Yodler whose yell
Wakes the echo in mountain or fell.
“Poor Echo!” I say,
“To be wakened each day
By a sound like a Feline unwell.”



Z is a Zealot whose zeal
Takes the form of an "*Urgent appeal*."
Tho' you wriggle and squirm
And protest—he sits firm,
Till he lands you at last like an eel.



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